

Pneumococcal Vaccine

Vaccination safety requirements

The signed PGD behind this page is unaltered. This correction takes precedence over it.

What is missing from the signed document

- No requirement for adrenaline.
- No cold chain excursion procedure.
- No sharps disposal provision.

What must be in place before you vaccinate under this PGD

- Adrenaline (epinephrine) 1 in 1,000 injection must be immediately available in the room where vaccination takes place, in date, together with a telephone.
- A written anaphylaxis protocol consistent with current Resuscitation Council UK guidance must be available, and every person administering must be trained in the recognition and immediate management of anaphylaxis and hold current basic life support training.
- Observe every patient for 15 minutes after vaccination. Vaccinate seated, and have procedures in place to prevent injury from a faint.
- Record the batch number and the anatomical site for every dose given. A recall cannot be actioned without the batch number.

If these are not in place

Do not vaccinate under this PGD. This is not a documentation point: anaphylaxis after vaccination is rare, and it is the thing that kills. The requirement exists so that the one time it happens, the adrenaline is in the room.

Why this notice exists

A review of every vaccination PGD on the platform on 8 September 2026 found that these requirements were stated in some signed documents and not others. Where they were absent, nothing in the signed document required adrenaline to be present. Pharmacies almost certainly have it and are trained; the problem is that the document did not require it, so it was not evidenced anywhere if anyone asked.

A corrected version of this PGD will be issued and will carry these requirements in the body of the document. Until then, this notice applies.

This Patient Group Direction (PGD) is intended only for registered healthcare professionals who have been named and authorised by their organisation to practice under it.

Patient Group Direction

for the administration of Pneumovax 23 or Prevenar 13 to vaccinate against Pneumococcal Disease

Summary of NICE / NICE CKS Guidelines for Pneumococcal Vaccination

Overview

- Pneumococcal disease is caused by *Streptococcus pneumoniae*, leading to infections such as **pneumonia**, **septicaemia**, and **meningitis**.
- Vaccination is aimed at **preventing invasive pneumococcal disease (IPD)**, especially in high-risk groups.

Types of Pneumococcal Vaccines Used in the UK

1. **PCV15 or PCV13** (Prevenar 15 / 13):
 - **Conjugate vaccines** — used in infants and selected high-risk groups.
2. **PPSV23** (Pneumovax 23):
 - **Polysaccharide vaccine** — protects against 23 serotypes.
 - Used in adults and older children at risk of IPD.

Routine Childhood Schedule (UK)

- **PCV15 (or PCV13)** is given as:
 - **First dose at 12 weeks**
 - **Booster at 1 year** (as part of routine infant immunisation)

Note: The exact schedule may vary based on updated UKHSA recommendations.

At-Risk Groups (Eligible for Additional Vaccination)

Offer **PPSV23** (or PCV plus PPSV23) to individuals aged **2 years and over** with:

- **Chronic respiratory, heart, kidney, liver or neurological conditions**

- **Diabetes**
- **Immunosuppression** (e.g. HIV, chemotherapy, asplenia)
- **Cochlear implants**
- **CSF leaks**
- **Sickle cell disease or other haemoglobinopathies**

High-risk children under 2 years may receive **additional PCV doses** on a tailored schedule.

Older Adults

- **All adults aged 65 years** are offered a **single dose of PPSV23**, unless already vaccinated.

Vaccination Schedule by Risk Group (Simplified)

Group	Vaccine	Notes
Infants	PCV15/13 at 12 weeks + booster at 1 year	Routine
Adults ≥65	PPSV23 (one-off)	Even if healthy
At-risk ≥2 years	PPSV23	May also need PCV if never received
Severely immunocompromised	PCV followed by PPSV23 after ≥8 weeks	Requires specialist input

Contraindications

- Severe allergic reaction to previous dose or vaccine component.
- Acute febrile illness (defer until recovery).

Side Effects

- Mild: redness, swelling, pain at injection site; low-grade fever
- Rare: allergic reaction

Co-Administration

- Can be given with other vaccines (e.g. flu, COVID-19), in a different limb or site.

Documentation

- Record **vaccine name, batch number, site, date, and route.**
- Report adverse reactions via the **Yellow Card Scheme.**

Patient Group Direction

for the supply/administration of

Pneumovax 23

for vaccination against

Pneumococcal Disease

Healthcare professionals covered and training

	Healthcare professionals allowed to work under this PGD and requirements
Qualifications and Registration	● Pharmacist registered and practicing with the GPhC ● Pharmacy technician registered and practicing with the GPhC
Training and assessment	● Pharmacists and Pharmacy Technicians must have completed training relevant to this condition to use this PGD. This training will be documented and overseen by the Get Real Health team. ● All users must be familiar with the SPC for the products as well as BNF advice and any applicable national guidelines ● All users must previously have used PGD's to supply medication ● Must work in compliance with the SOPs of their own employer ● All users must have appropriate indemnity in place to cover this service
Further training and responsibilities	● All users must be up to date with CPD requirements and appraisal ● All users must be up to date with MHRA and safety alerts with regards to medical products ● All users must understand the concepts of capacity and consent and be aware of the Mental Capacity Act 2005.

PGD Indication	Pneumovax 23 is indicated for active immunisation against pneumococcal disease caused by the 23 serotypes included in the vaccine for individuals aged 2 years and over at increased risk, in accordance with national guidance.
Inclusion criteria	- Individuals aged 2 years and over eligible for pneumococcal vaccination under national guidance. - Informed consent obtained from the individual or guardian. - No contraindications to pneumococcal vaccination.
Exclusion criteria	- Known hypersensitivity to Pneumovax 23 or any of its components. - Previous severe allergic reaction to any pneumococcal vaccine. - Acute illness with fever (postpone until recovered).
Cautions	- Use with caution in individuals with bleeding disorders. - Record batch number and site of administration. - Monitor for anaphylaxis for 15 minutes after administration. - Inform patient of possible side effects and when to seek help.
Actions if patient is excluded or declines treatment	Advise on alternative treatment options and how these can be accessed. Document any advice given and the decision reached. Inform or refer to the GP as appropriate

Details of the medicine

Name, form and strength of medicine	Pneumovax 23
Legal category	POM
Storage	Store in a refrigerator (2°C–8°C). Do not freeze. Protect from light.
Route/method of administration	Intramuscular or subcutaneous injection.
Dose and frequency	Single 0.5 mL dose. Revaccination may be considered after 5 years in high-risk individuals.
Quantity to be administered and/or supplied	0.5 mL per dose.
Maximum or minimum treatment period	One lifetime dose in most cases. Repeat only under specific clinical recommendations.
Adverse effects	Injection site pain, redness, swelling, fever, fatigue, headache. Rare: allergic reactions. Refer to SmPC.

Yellow card reporting	Report suspected adverse effects via https://yellowcard.mhra.gov.uk and inform the GP as appropriate.
Records to be kept	Record the following information: ● that valid informed consent was given ● name of individual, address, date of birth and GP ● name of healthcare practitioner ● name and brand of medication ● date of supply dose, form and route quantity supplied ● advice given, including advice given if excluded or declines treatment ● details of any adverse drug reactions and actions taken supplied via PGD Records should be signed and dated. All records should be clear, legible and contemporaneous. Electronic records can be made. A record of all individuals receiving treatment under this PGD should also be kept for audit purposes as follows: ● Adults aged 18 years and over - keep records for 8 years ● Children aged under 18 years -keep records until the 25th birthday (if the patient was 17 years when treatment was finished, keep records until the 26th birthday)

Patient information

Written information to be given to patient or carer	Supply the patient information leaflet (PIL) provided with the medication.
Follow-up advice to be given to patient or carer	To seek medical advice if symptoms worsen rapidly or significantly, do not improve in 3–4 weeks, or they become systemically very unwell.

Key references

- NICE Medicines Practice Guideline 2 (MPG2): Patient Group Directions. Published March 2017 <https://www.nice.org.uk/guidance/mpg2>
- NICE MPG2 Patient group directions: competency framework for health professionals using patient group directions. Updated March 2017 <https://www.nice.org.uk/guidance/mpg2/resources>
- NICE CKS Guidance
- British National Formulary (BNF) Key information on the selection, prescribing, dispensing and administration of medicines [BNF \(British National Formulary\) | NICE](#)
- Summary of Product Characteristics

Agreement to practise by the Registered Healthcare Professional

By signing this PGD you are confirming that you agree to its contents and that you will work within it. PGDs do not remove inherent professional obligations or accountability. It is the responsibility of each healthcare professional to practise only within the bounds of their own competence and professional code of conduct.

Name and address of pharmacy premises / clinic premises to which this PGD relates

Name of healthcare professional	Job title	Registration number	Signature
Valid from date		Expiry date	
25/8/26		31/7/27	

PGD adoption and authorisation by the employer/clinical lead

The employer has ensured that the person using this PGD, has the knowledge and skills to safely provide the service which will encompass the supply or administration of a medication or medicine.

This section must be signed by the superintendent or clinical lead responsible for this service.

Name of superintendent / clinical lead	Job title & name of organisation	Signature	Date

Name of professional group signatory	Job title & name of organisation	Signature	Date
--------------------------------------	----------------------------------	-----------	------

Signed on behalf of Get Real Health

Name	Qualification	Signature	Date
Nitin Shori	Medical Doctor GMC: 6047293		25/08/2025
Chris Pilkington	Pharmacist GPhC: 2046322		25/08/2025

Change history

Version number	Change details	Date
001	Development & issue of new PGD	25 th June 2025

Patient Group Direction

for the supply/administration of

Prevenar 13

for vaccination against

Pneumococcal Disease

Healthcare professionals covered and training

	Healthcare professionals allowed to work under this PGD and requirements
Qualifications and Registration	● Pharmacist registered and practicing with the GPhC ● Pharmacy technician registered and practicing with the GPhC
Training and assessment	● Pharmacists and Pharmacy Technicians must have completed training relevant to this condition to use this PGD. This training will be documented and overseen by the Get Real Health team. ● All users must be familiar with the SPC for the products as well as BNF advice and any applicable national guidelines ● All users must previously have used PGD's to supply medication ● Must work in compliance with the SOPs of their own employer ● All users must have appropriate indemnity in place to cover this service
Further training and responsibilities	● All users must be up to date with CPD requirements and appraisal ● All users must be up to date with MHRA and safety alerts with regards to medical products ● All users must understand the concepts of capacity and consent and be aware of the Mental Capacity Act 2005.

PGD Indication	Prevenar 13 is indicated for active immunisation against pneumococcal disease caused by the 13 serotypes included in the vaccine, for infants, children, and adults in accordance with the national immunisation programme and clinical risk group recommendations.
Inclusion criteria	- Individuals eligible for pneumococcal vaccination under national childhood or adult immunisation programmes. - Informed consent obtained from individual or guardian. - No contraindications to Prevenar 13.
Exclusion criteria	- Known hypersensitivity to the active substance or any component of the vaccine. - Severe allergic reaction to a previous pneumococcal conjugate vaccine. - Acute febrile illness (postpone vaccination until recovery).
Cautions	- Observe the patient for 15 minutes post-vaccination. - Use with caution in patients with bleeding disorders. - Record batch number and expiry date in the patient record. - Advise on expected side effects and when to seek medical advice.
Actions if patient is excluded or declines treatment	Advise on alternative treatment options and how these can be accessed. Document any advice given and the decision reached. Inform or refer to the GP as appropriate

Details of the medicine

Name, form and strength of medicine	Prevenar 13
Legal category	POM
Storage	Store in a refrigerator (2°C–8°C). Do not freeze. Protect from light.
Route/method of administration	Intramuscular injection.
Dose and frequency	0.5 mL per dose according to the national immunisation schedule.
Quantity to be administered and/or supplied	0.5 mL per dose.
Maximum or minimum treatment period	As per national immunisation schedule, including primary and booster doses.
Adverse effects	Irritability, drowsiness, loss of appetite, fever, injection site redness/swelling. Rare: hypersensitivity reactions. Refer to SmPC.

Yellow card reporting	Report suspected adverse effects via https://yellowcard.mhra.gov.uk and inform the GP as appropriate.
Records to be kept	Record the following information: ● that valid informed consent was given ● name of individual, address, date of birth and GP ● name of healthcare practitioner ● name and brand of medication ● date of supply dose, form and route quantity supplied ● advice given, including advice given if excluded or declines treatment ● details of any adverse drug reactions and actions taken supplied via PGD Records should be signed and dated. All records should be clear, legible and contemporaneous. Electronic records can be made. A record of all individuals receiving treatment under this PGD should also be kept for audit purposes as follows: ● Adults aged 18 years and over - keep records for 8 years ● Children aged under 18 years -keep records until the 25th birthday (if the patient was 17 years when treatment was finished, keep records until the 26th birthday)

Patient information

Written information to be given to patient or carer	Supply the patient information leaflet (PIL) provided with the medication.
Follow-up advice to be given to patient or carer	To seek medical advice if symptoms worsen rapidly or significantly, do not improve in 3–4 weeks, or they become systemically very unwell.

Key references

- NICE Medicines Practice Guideline 2 (MPG2): Patient Group Directions. Published March 2017 <https://www.nice.org.uk/guidance/mpg2>
- NICE MPG2 Patient group directions: competency framework for health professionals using patient group directions. Updated March 2017 <https://www.nice.org.uk/guidance/mpg2/resources>
- NICE CKS Guidance
- British National Formulary (BNF) Key information on the selection, prescribing, dispensing and administration of medicines [BNF \(British National Formulary\) | NICE](#)
- Summary of Product Characteristics

Agreement to practise by the Registered Healthcare Professional

By signing this PGD you are confirming that you agree to its contents and that you will work within it. PGDs do not remove inherent professional obligations or accountability. It is the responsibility of each healthcare professional to practise only within the bounds of their own competence and professional code of conduct.

Name and address of pharmacy premises / clinic premises to which this PGD relates

Name of healthcare professional	Job title	Registration number	Signature
Valid from date		Expiry date	
25/8/26		31/7/27	

PGD adoption and authorisation by the employer/clinical lead

The employer has ensured that the person using this PGD, has the knowledge and skills to safely provide the service which will encompass the supply or administration of a medication or medicine.

This section must be signed by the superintendent or clinical lead responsible for this service.

Name of superintendent / clinical lead	Job title & name of organisation	Signature	Date

Name of professional group signatory	Job title & name of organisation	Signature	Date
--------------------------------------	----------------------------------	-----------	------

Signed on behalf of Get Real Health

Name	Qualification	Signature	Date
Nitin Shori	Medical Doctor GMC: 6047293		25/08/2025
Chris Pilkington	Pharmacist GPhC: 2046322		25/08/2025

Change history

Version number	Change details	Date
001	Development & issue of new PGD	25 th June 2025